

MD-0005: Steering Committee Composition and Signatory Authority

Field	Value
ID	MD-0005
Type	MD, Maintainer Decision
Status	Accepted
Normative?	No. Records a governance decision; changes no dataset conformance requirement.
Visibility	Public (standard governance)
Proposed date	2026-07-28, the date the Signature Copy was generated and circulated. The executed document carries no Proposed date field; this is the earliest date evidenced by an artifact.
Accepted date	2026-07-28
Deciders	Steering Committee / maintainers (Princeton Medical Systems)
Related	GOVERNANCE.md; MD-0001; MD-0002; SOP-VIDS-Governance-Handbook-v1.0; REG-DOC

Decision

Effective the acceptance date recorded above:

- 1. Recording, not constituting.** This decision records the current composition of the VIDS Steering Committee. It does not create a new committee.
- 2. Composition.** The Steering Committee consists of: Dr. Joan S. Muthu, Co-Founder and CTO; John Shalen R., Co-Founder and COO; John Xavier, Co-Founder and Head of US and Global Operations.
- 3. Signatory authority.** All Steering Committee members hold governance signatory authority.
- 4. Membership recording rule.** Future appointments, resignations, removals, or changes to Steering Committee membership shall be recorded through a Maintainer Decision. Each such decision applies only from its stated effective date.
- 5. Prior decisions unaffected.** MD-0001 through MD-0004 remain exactly as approved. They are not amended, re-signed, or reinterpreted.
- 6. Charter update.** GOVERNANCE.md shall be updated to reflect the current Steering Committee composition, state the rule in clause 4, and reference this decision.

Rationale

VIDS governance is transitioning from its initial operating structure to a permanent governance model. This decision formally records the Steering Committee membership, establishes signatory authority for future governance decisions, and defines how future membership changes will be documented.

Application

GOVERNANCE.md gains a Steering Committee Membership provision reading: "The current composition of the Steering Committee is recorded through Maintainer Decisions (MDs). Appointments, resignations, and removals are recorded by subsequent MDs, each applying from its stated effective date." The principal list is updated to match clause 2, with a charter change-log entry referencing MD-0005.

Subsequent MDs, appointment confirmations, and governance instruments carry the signatory set in clause 3. The public website governance page is updated on the effective date.

Scope note

This decision applies only to VIDS governance. It does not change: previous governance decisions; publication authorship, which reflects contribution as declared at submission; commercial signing authority for Princeton Medical Systems contracts; Princeton Medical Systems partnership agreements; or the operation and attribution of organizational accounts, which are infrastructure and are not attributed to individuals.

Consultation & decision record

Item	Record
Review window	Signature Copy generated and circulated 2026-07-28; executed the same day. Dates preceding circulation are not evidenced by any artifact available at filing.
Advisory Council opinion	None requested (internal governance composition)
Method	Consensus; approved by all three seated members without dissent
Vote count (if voted)	Not put to a vote. Unanimous approval of 3 of 3 seated members exceeds the two-thirds-of-seats threshold for membership items under Handbook §7.
Recusals	None
Dissents	None

Sign-off

Maintainer	Decision	Approval date
Dr. Joan S. Muthu	Approved	2026-07-28
John Shalen R.	Approved	2026-07-28
John Xavier	Approved	2026-07-28

Approval evidence: MD-0005-ApprovalEvidence-2026-07-28.pdf

Acceptance took effect on the latest date of signature. Signatures completed 2026-07-28; the execution platform recorded completion of all three signatures at 16:11:47 UTC. This rendering contains no signature lines; signatures are held in the approval evidence cited above.

Change log

Date	Change
2026-07-28	Initial draft (Proposed).
2026-07-28	Accepted following approval by Dr. Joan S. Muthu, John Shalen R., and John Xavier.

MD-0005 is a governance-process decision. It is non-normative with respect to dataset conformance.